

# Workplace Drug & Alcohol Policy

## Title: Workplace Drug & Alcohol Policy

First Derivatives is committed to ensuring a safe and professional environment for employees.

It recognizes that this can be put at risk by those who misuse alcohol or drugs to such an extent that it may affect their health, performance, conduct and relationships at work.

The effects of alcohol and drugs at work can lead to reduced levels of attendance, reduced efficiency and performance, impaired judgement & decision-making and increased health & safety risks of the individual, other employees and clients.

Irresponsible behavior or the commission of offences resulting from the misuse of alcohol or drugs may also damage the company's brand and reputation.

## Aim

- Support employees who are experiencing difficulty with alcohol, drugs and/or substance abuse.
- Set out the company's policy on alcohol, drugs and substance misuse within the workplace.
- Minimize the risks caused by or associated with alcohol and drugs at work
- Ensure the company complies with appropriate legislation in the country you are employed

## Scope

The policy applies to all employees and contractors of the company.

## Terminology

### Alcohol Abuse

Any drinking, either intermittent or continual, which interferes with health and/or social functioning and/or work capability or conduct.

### Drugs

Illegal, prescribed, OTC medicines/solvents and legal drugs.

With regards to prescribed and OTC drugs, their possession and use by the employee may be legitimate.

## **Drug Abuse**

The use of illegal drugs, the deliberate misuse of prescribed or OTC drugs, and the use of solvents, either intermittent or continuous, which interfere with health and/or social functioning and/or work capability or conduct.

## **General Principles**

The company requires all employees to come to work free from the effects of alcohol and drugs.

Working under the influence of alcohol or drugs or consuming alcohol or drugs during working hours is unacceptable behavior.

- If you are found in possession of illegal drugs while at work, this will be reported to the local authorities.
- If legitimate use of prescribed drugs is likely to affect your performance or safety at work, you should inform your PTL immediately.

Failure to comply with this policy will be dealt via the company's disciplinary procedure.

## **Misconduct**

This policy is principally concerned with ongoing issues of substance misuse.

The company classes these as 'capability issues' as the problem will primarily impact how an employee performs their role.

In circumstances where an employee breaches the policy on an individual case, such as being under the influence of alcohol or drugs at work, the company will classify this behavior as gross misconduct and will deal with it via the normal disciplinary procedures.

## **Referrals**

The policy outlines the procedures in relation to both voluntary and management referrals.

## **Voluntary**

Employees who suspect or know they have an alcohol or drug problem are encouraged to seek support as early as possible. Where an employee makes a voluntary referral they will

be provided with the appropriate support internal or external where necessary to address the issue.

## **Management**

PTL will offer support to employees who are suspect of having alcohol or drug problems. The company understands that alcohol or drug problems can develop for a variety of reasons and over a period of time.

Alcohol and drug dependency are treatable conditions, the company is committed as far as possible to treating these problems in a similar way to other health issues.

## **Drug Screening**

The company may carry out drug testing on employees.

## **Confidentiality**

The company aims to ensure that all matters surrounding alcohol or drug problems are dealt with sensitively and confidentiality.

All appropriate employees such as Occupational Health and People Team will respect confidentiality for any employee who are experiencing problems with alcohol or drugs as far as possible.

Information should only be divulged where it would comprise the company's reputation or any employee's safety by not doing so.

## **Policy Review**

The policy will be reviewed regularly by the People Team and as required, upon the introduction of new legislation in the jurisdiction within which First Derivatives operates.